CHRISTEN BLACK

Ph.D. - Economics

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Christen Black

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SKILLS

Python/RStudio 5+ yrs

Latex 4+ yrs

Tutoring 4+ yrs

COURSE WORK

Microeconomic Theory II&III (Ph.D.)

A deep dive into producer, consumer & game theory.
In this course we looked at various consumer theories and focus in on how consumers best maximize their utility under constraints

Macroeconomic Theory II&III (Ph.D.)

A deep dive into various models and the theories that drive these models
We learned about various models. Not only did we cover the basic fundamental theories but we also aimed the stay up to date on current theories and models such as Menu Costs. A model developed by Treasury Secretary Janet Yellen to explain price changes in an economy.

Labor Economics I, II & III (Ph.D.)

Advanced labor market theory and applied empirical methods

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics **2023 – 2026**
Howard University, Washington, D.C.

- Advanced training in microeconomic theory, econometrics, and applied research contributing to dissertation work.

M.A. Economics **2021 – 2023**
Old Dominion University, Norfolk, VA

- Graduate-level training in econometrics, statistical programming in R, and applied policy analysis.

B.S. Economics **2015 – 2020**
Hampton University, Hampton, VA

- Foundation in applied microeconomics, macroeconomics, and managerial economics; Dean's List (2019–2020).

RESEARCH

- **Earnings Differentials of HBCU Graduates**
  - Examined earnings differentials between high school graduates who attended HBCUs and those who did not, analyzing their likelihood of earning more than peers who never attended college.
  - Utilized restricted-access survey data and regression models to control for selection bias and family background effects.
- **Conjugal Visit Laws and Sexual Assault in Prisons**
  - Examined the relationship between conjugal visit policy changes and rates of sexual assault within correctional facilities.
  - Analyzed whether shifts in conjugal visit laws correspond to measurable changes in intra-prison sexual violence using panel data and regression methods.
- **Volunteer Fire Departments and Emergency Response Times**
  - Investigated how the presence of volunteer versus career fire departments affects emergency response times across municipalities.
  - Assessed the implications of staffing model differences for public safety outcomes and local government resource allocation.

Covered wage determination, labor supply and demand, discrimination, unions, and labor market inequality with emphasis on econometric applications and policy evaluation.

Urban Economics I, II & III (Ph.D.)

Urban theory, spatial economics, and applied policy analysis
Studied housing markets, land use, transportation, segregation, and local public finance using spatial data and empirical urban policy methods.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Visiting Assistant Professor of Economics — **2026–Present**
Florida A&M University, Tallahassee, FL

- Teach in the School of Business and Industry: Industrial Organization, Managerial Economics, and Money, Banking, and Financial Markets on a 3-3 course load.
- Build course materials, including chapter-by-chapter lecture slides, homework, and exams.
- Continue research and publication from dissertation work alongside teaching.

Board Secretary & Events Coordinator — **2024–Present**
Lorton Volunteer Fire Department, Lorton, VA

- Serve on the Board of Directors, supporting governance, documentation, and organizational planning.
- Coordinate community events and hall rentals that support outreach and operational revenue.

Adjunct Instructor of Economics — **Summer 2024**
Hampton University, Hampton, VA

- Taught Principles of Microeconomics and Principles of Macroeconomics to undergraduate students.
- Designed course materials, assessments, and lectures aligned with departmental learning objectives.
- Provided academic mentoring and office hour support to promote student engagement and performance.

Graduate Researcher — **2023–2026**
Howard University, Washington, D.C.

- Conduct research in labor and urban economics with a focus on racial wage disparities, unionization, and the role of historically Black colleges and universities (HBCUs).
- Collaborate with faculty on empirical projects using large-scale datasets and R for econometric modeling and visualization.

Fellow, American Economic Association Summer Program (AEASP) — **Summer 2025**
Howard University / Federal Reserve Board

- Selected as a competitive fellow for the AEA Summer Program focused on advancing underrepresented groups in economics.
- Helped students conduct econometrics research and presented findings to academic mentors and Federal Reserve economists and other institutions across DC.